

NICK VAN ASTEN

GAME DESIGN & DEVELOPMENT • Portfolio

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PROFILE

ICT student at Fontys University of Applied Sciences with a growing focus on game design and game development. Interested in creating engaging gameplay experiences by combining level design, game mechanics, narrative, and atmosphere. Experienced in collaborative game projects and individual prototypes, including work in Unreal Engine. Motivated to expand technical skills, experiment with new ideas, and turn creative concepts into playable experiences.

EDUCATION

Fontys University of Applied Sciences — **2024–Present**

Information & Communication Technology (ICT) · Expected graduation: 2029

Relevant experience in game design and game development through semester-based projects.

WereDi Secondary School, Valkenswaard — **2019–2024**

HAVO Diploma

GAME DESIGN PROJECTS · SEMESTER 3

Tower Clash

Game Designer · Solo continuation of a group project | Physical board game · 3–4 players

- Redesigned a two-week group project from its original Mario-inspired concept into a medieval castle-themed strategy game.
- Designed rules for a 7×7 board where players build towers, climb structures, block opponents, and race to reach the crown.
- Designed a 78-card system across seven categories, including movement, defence, board control, and risk-based mechanics.
- Built a physical prototype using LEGO bricks and a paper board to test movement, tower heights, and climbing rules.
- Used playtesting to evaluate rule clarity and core gameplay, identifying areas for further balancing and refinement.

You Are Haunted

Game Designer · VR horror duo project

- Contributed to map design, considering room layout, environmental storytelling, and the placement of gameplay elements.
- Worked on sound design to support horror, atmosphere, and player immersion.
- Explored how level progression, environmental design, and audio cues could work together to build tension.

Pack

Game Designer · Solo project | Unreal Engine · One-week project

- Developed an original escape-game concept inspired by Squid Game and Saw as part of an introductory Unreal Engine assignment.
- Designed a sequence of challenge rooms built around puzzles.
- Created the concept for The Pack, a host character who guides and mocks the player through dark humour and dialogue.

GAME DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS · SEMESTER 2

Sublevel

Team Project · Game Developer | Unreal Engine · 8 weeks · Team of 3

- Developed gameplay systems for a first-person horror game set in an abandoned underground bunker.
- Implemented player movement and a unified interaction system for doors, valves, keycards, pickups, and hiding spots using Unreal Engine Blueprints.
- Designed and implemented environmental audio, ambient soundscapes, interaction sounds, and warning cues to build tension and improve immersion.
- Created scripted environmental events and jumpscares to support horror pacing and player suspense.

Project Splitstar

Game Developer · Team Project | 2.5D Space Shooter · Player Systems

- Implemented player movement, rotation, aiming, shooting mechanics, and power-ups for a fast-paced 2.5D space shooter.
- Refined player controls to support responsive movement and independent aiming during combat.
- Developed a segmented health system inspired by My Friend Pedro, including a dedicated health component, damage and healing logic, and real-time UI updates.
- Implemented a Bastion shield mechanic that absorbs incoming damage before it affects the player's regular health.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Day Activity Support Assistant · Wenshof

Supported daytime activities for older adults, including people experiencing memory difficulties and early-stage dementia.

- Supported participants during activities under the supervision of the activity coordinator and helped maintain a welcoming, respectful environment.
- Contributed activities such as Rummikub or Sjoelen and assisted with preparation, meals, refreshments, table service, and general housekeeping.
- Encouraged participants' independence and supported mobility when needed.

SKILLS

GAME DESIGN	TECHNICAL	PERSONAL
• Gameplay and game-flow design	• Unreal Engine	• Creative and eager to learn
• Level and map design	• Unity	• Reliable and responsible
• Narrative and character concepts	• Godot	• Respectful and considerate
• Atmosphere and sound design		• Teamwork and collaboration
• Concept development and prototyping		• Problem-solving and experimentation

LANGUAGES

Dutch — Native | English — Add proficiency level | German — Add proficiency level